



The Purple Pen

Eleanor Ellis

NEXT ISSUE: Spring 2020

DELIGHTFUL

DARWEN?

The annual night and day event for PFO took place at Darwen Moor, on the weekend commencing the 7th of December.

For the night – 7th of December.

Tough one this! I mean, of course, tough to plan.

Kevan Latham (SELOC) suggested, as Controllers do, that I should minimize the number of passes through the slow spongy-mossy-heathery stuff, so courses with longer path options were the final offerings. Some may say I didn't follow his suggestion at all!

Even without any of the slow undergrowth, the navigation would have been tricky, especially in the areas of sketchy shallow features. Good attack points and accurate compass work was key. Looking at Routegadget it seems that the lead competitors mastered this admirably. Because of the slowness of the terrain, some thought they had done badly, only to discover top 5 placing. The Night Blue winning time was actually quicker than the estimated time of 65 to 70 minutes. Green was won in just under my 60 minutes.

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One consequence of the tough going and tricky navigation was a high fall-out rate: 19% overall = Blue 2%, Green taking the major hit of 28% and Orange 0%. Too high overall.

Everyone agreed it was tough, but some stated they had enjoyed their course!

Despite the conditions there was only one mishap. A failed head torch led to a bail-out to the north instead of the east, eventually reaching the A666 at the wrong end of the town. A call to the organiser and a rescue vehicle was dispatched.

First lesson: make sure your back-up head torch is powerful enough to read a map.

Second lesson: always print an emergency number on the map

For the day – 8th December.

Where to start? At the beginning I suppose.

More than half the controls were put out the day before for Darwen Moor Night event, plus a few extras for the day event –



but all these needed waking up in the morning. Max Cole rose long before dawn to put in a 2 ½ hour stint, through adverse terrain and adverse weather, just so that

the early starters could save a half second at each control. This left Kev and myself to put out 19 controls, plus taping and stile making on the Sunday morning. Max again stepping in to help with the last few controls.

At the early time of the day the rain, sleet and hail lashed alternately. So, you must all feel smug no rain fell throughout the competition. If you had time to admire the view you would have seen heavy rain afar passing us by. A bit of Irish luck must have fallen into the eye of the storm!

My comments for the night event apply equally to the day event. Kev controller “suggested” keeping shorter courses put of the knew deep pillows of undergrowth. I half complied such that the courses were better and winning times were in the expected range.

Thanks, must go to all the helpers on the event who ensured it all would run smoothly.

In summary I do believe the courses were tough, fair and, deep down, satisfying. Overall the retirement rate was 13% however no one complained about the map, just the terrain!

→ Credits to George Crawford Smith
(planner)

SUCCESS AT SANDRINGHAM

On the 7th of July, eight juniors represented Pendle Forest at Sandringham, Norfolk in the Yvette Baker Shield. A new addition to the Yvette Baker Trophy for the clubs with lesser juniors to give them a fair chance.

We successfully managed to gain 2nd place just 2 points beneath the winners.

The terrain was fairly easy going with a network of irregular paths, a wooded scarp slope and a semi-open woodland at Dersingham Common. Although the Bracken was 6ft tall, so it was more of a jungle adventure along the elephant tracks in hope for a control at the end than an orienteering course.

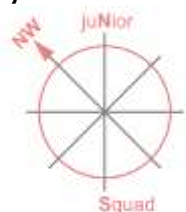
Congratulations to Oliver Bland on Yellow, Mustapha Khan on Orange, Eleanor Ellis on Green for all gaining 100 points.



From left back to right front: Mustapha Khan, Christian Wood, Eleanor Ellis, William Ellis, Neve Butcher, Gabriela Hoyle, Alex Butcher, Oliver Bland.

17-01-2020

Issue 1



The North West Junior Squad

--- William Ellis

Hello, I am one of the members of the North West Junior Orienteering Squad. Over the last year we have done extensive training in a wide range of the greatest areas in the northwest. We do a lot of work on map reading, compass work and picturing the terrain to name a few. In September we had the fitness day up in Lancaster, this consists of a coopers run, a beep test and other exercises including plank variations and lunges. During this day we have to reach the targets set by the coaches for our given age class (mine being M14). A few months after this in December we had the annual squad Christmas bash hosted and planned by the M/W18s that are leaving that year. Louis and Ben planned some excellent courses including a hunter score course and a course with activities at all the controls. This was then followed up by an excellent Christmas meal prepared by some of the parents of members of the squad. During the meal, awards were given out for things such as most and fastest park runs. This year I received my north west squad top for reaching the required standards for my age, which I have to say fits absolutely splendidly.

MEMBERSHIP

Hopefully you have all renewed your membership for 2020, if not our current membership fees are:

→ Adults £25.00

→ Juniors £8.00

You can follow the link on the homepage of our website at www.pfo.org.uk or going directly to British Orienteering website via the link http://www.britishorienteering.org.uk/join_online

(Any more questions see Andy Ellis)

TOO MUCH HASSLE?

Have you thought about setting up a direct debit?

Details and the direct debit mandate form are available on the BOF website via this link http://www.britishorienteering.org.uk/new_membership



A summer of orienteering with the Woods

Week 1 Scottish 6 days Strathearn 28th July – 3rd August 2019

With Christian away on a school trip, Andy and I took full advantage and headed up to Scotland for a childfree week of Orienteering at the Scottish 6 days. The 2019 week long orienteering festival was based around Crieff, we had elected to stay on the event campsite at Comrie Croft along with Helen and Andy Ellis and Richard Edwards, plus a further 200 plus orienteers from around the world.



We couldn't have wished for better weather! We saw little rain for the whole of the week; Paul Wright and I even enjoyed a little open water swimming in Loch Earn.

For anyone who hasn't experienced orienteering in Scotland or the Scottish 6 Days, prepare yourselves! The courses are more technical than most places in England and the assembly areas and starts can be almost as far as the courses themselves (sometimes further).

Having said that, the scenery is spectacular with events in a variety of locations throughout the week.

My personal favourite for the week was based at St Fillan's Golf Club. The photo speaks volumes.



We travelled to most events by the event bus which is booked when entering and a regular service picks you up from the campsite and takes you directly to the event and brings you back again after your run, but you have to make sure you make the last bus back or you could be landed with a hefty taxi bill back to your campsite! Luckily Dave Rose was on hand to perform

a Starsky and Hutch type manoeuvre in his mini to ensure Richard was delivered from the event centre to the last bus with only minutes to spare!



It was great to see so many PFO members there this year, Richard, Dave, Paul, Bridget, Joanne, the Coles and the Ellis', Jim, Mary, Chris Mitchell even made an appearance, and thank you to Max, Ella and Billie for hosting a club Barbeque at their luxury cottage. Thanks also to Mary who kindly took our kit for a proper wash mid-week, delivering it back to us freshly laundered the next day!



I haven't mentioned the orienteering much mainly because I have no idea where I've been, but also you just have to experience it for yourselves to find out what it's really like, but don't count on improving your ranking score!

You can look at the maps on route gadget if you are interested.

Week 2 Sweden/Norway 7th August -18th August 2019

Week 2 of our summer of orienteering took us further afield. Some swift unpacking, washing and repacking saw us heading to Sweden and Norway. We had entered the spectator races at the World



Championships and were taking advantage of the kind offer of accommodation at my friend Kerstin's house in Sweden close to the Norwegian border. All the events being within an hour and a half drive.

Feeling very prepared following from the Scottish 6 Days, we landed at Kerstin's to be transported immediately to a local practice event! Any Scottish confidence soon evaporated as I bumbled my way around a 3 km course in an hour and a bit!

Swedish and Norwegian terrain is different again,



mostly granite, but with endless forest and bilberry undergrowth. I am told there are paths through the forest, but in 6 days I didn't find one!

More practice was needed and Kerstin had very kindly found a weekend event in

Sweden to help us along (this would be my 8th and 9th race in 2 weeks!) good job we had good company because after these 2 appetisers I was close to retiring from the sport all together!



Boyed up by red wine and prosecco the evening before, I approached the first day in Norway with more enthusiasm and to my surprise didn't get too lost. (In a Norwegian forest you can get lost within 2 minutes of leaving the start!) The maps and courses look straightforward enough on paper but get into the forest and it's another world. And so the week progressed.....

The World Championships arenas have large screens showing live tracking of the elite athletes and the

racers are covered on national TV much like football in the UK. There are thousands of spectators at the event centres.



Watching the national elite gliding effortlessly through the forest made me wonder if someone had gone out and done a bit of pruning in advance!

By the end of the week I'd used my compass more than I'd ever done before in my life and I was counting paces in my sleep!

Andy with our friend Hans on Swedish event transport.



Norwegian rain, poor Chris was running for over an hour in this monsoon!

In 3 weeks I'd completed 16 events (if you include the sprints in both Scotland and Norway) and a training event and I think I went down 30 ranking places! And if you're wondering what the courses were like, they were hard, very hard! There is a Scandinavian equivalent of route gadget if you really want to know more!



A SIAC Q&A

What is SIAC?

SIAC is the new generation of SportIdent 'dibbers'. SIAC stands for SportIdent Active Card.

What turns the SIAC dibber on?

Dibbing clear and the check box will turn the dibber on, if the event is SIAC enabled. *(if you are at an event and SIAC is enabled and there is no check box it is worth asking a start official, as they probably have it in their pocket!)*

What turns the dibber off?

With the latest versions of the SI Timing software downloading will turn your SIAC dibber off.

If you retire during an event, then you need to make sure that you download to turn your dibber off. If you don't then it will automatically turn off after approximately 20 hours.

To check after an event: faint 'heartbeat' flash which can be seen in a dark environment, this will indicate it has not been turned off

How do I know my dibber is turned on?

Some events will have a SIAC test control in the start boxes. Wafting your dibber over this should cause you dibber to bleep and flash. If it doesn't then you may need to go back and Clear then Check.

What do I do at a control?

You 'waft' your hand over the control box and as long as it is withing about 50cm of the control the dibber will bleep and flash. You will often see participants running past a control and then holding their dibber to their ear to check it's picked up the control. In this instance the control box does not beep. If you find the dibber doesn't beep / flash, then you 'dib' as per a normal dibber.

How long does the battery last?

A few years, if the battery goes flat then you can return the dibber to SportIdent for a new battery, this will cost approximately £10.00

What happens if the battery is flat or it doesn't turn on?

In this case your dibber continues to function as a 'normal' dibber and must be 'dibbed' instead of wafting over control boxes.

Do I need to 'dib' Start and Finish?

Check event details, each event is different!

Most events will require you to 'dib' both the Start and Finish but some larger events may not have a Start box {in which case you must ensure you start at your allocated timeslot}, and then have a contactless Finish. In this case there will be a 'Safety Check' control adjacent to Finish which you must 'dib' to confirm that you are off the course.

(Any more questions see Andy Ellis)

CREDITS

- Chief Editor – Eleanor Ellis
- Credits – George Crawford-Smith
- Articles from – Andy Ellis, William Ellis and Judith Wood

CLUB NIGHT

- At Newchurch Primary School:
Wednesday night 6:45 – 8:15



PUZZLES

Hidden within this text there are the initials of at least 48 British orienteering clubs and associations. How many can you find?

Answers will appear in the next edition of this newsletter – Andy Ellis

Most of our members compete at northern events with occasional trips down south and many orienteers from around the world attend competitions such as the JK. Our areas include boroughs of Rossendale, Pendle and Accrington. Some historic houses have POCs, controls can be placed on features such as a new moat of ruined gatehouse if they are present at these locations. In East Anglia there is a POC at Wimpole Hall. In the North Lakes, Lowther Castle has a POC. Orienteering is a sport that all age groups can participate in, from toddlers in prams to grampas and grannies. Some parents run their course before shadowing their children on the white or yellow course so that they are competitive although winning your race often isn't as important as successfully completing it. Kids enjoy orienteering because they can be explorers in the undergrowth, and can go to find a conker now they've finished. The shortest courses are usually white or yellow and black for longer distance.

Orienteering events wouldn't happen without the huge amount of time that is put in by club members, many club members help at events prior to having their run, often with a brief stint on the start or finish. At events it's your responsibility to ensure you punch each control in the correct order. When orienteering on Pendle competitors should look out for remains of a cauldron going to their starts. Courses tend to get more challenging as the undergrowth grows, but every right decision can take vital seconds off your time, the best orienteers can stay on their chosen route. No matter how tired you feel, you should resist the temptation to stop for a rest. You should always check orienteering kit prior to events to make sure it's ready.

Planners sometimes wrestle with the best choice for control locations on courses, the aim of the planner is to provide good courses at all levels, they may include an odd number of controls and have often made extra effort to plan courses that offer more route choice. They try not to plan bad orienteering events. Sometimes the range of courses is extended with a long orange. Organisers need to manage the logistics of event management. Care must be taken to tidy up and avoid leaving litter and plastic which may suffocate small animals, we don't want to be responsible for the death of voles. Bats are nocturnal creatures and may be seen at night events. Most events now use SportIdent's SIAC air enabled dibbers. When in the woods you may sometimes hear a loud voice or call occasionally. Infrequently you may hear someone sob so alarmingly that on such occasions you consider getting help for them.

After an event a good wash down with soapy water will get rid of any mud, there's nothing better than relaxing on a sofa with a hot drink following an event it's a very social activity and it's the best job of the day. As a measure of IQ, orienteering is not proven to be an indicator.

In closing, our next event will be in Staghills Wood in February. There have been some notable achievements for our club members, my son won the M14 class at the Northern Champs at Wharnccliffe in 2019 and congratulations must go to Max Cole in being selected to compete (again) at this year's Interland competition.



CAPTION COMPETITION

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DATES FOR YOUR DIARY

- Beacon Fell training day – 25th January
- Stag Hills Woods – 1st February
- Alkincoats – 8th February
- Towneley Park – 29th February
- Peel Park – 7th March
- Compass Sport, Ogden Moor – 14th March
- JK, North East – 10th – 13th April

CONTACTS

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chairman@pfo.org.uk - (Judith Wood)

Instagram: pendleforestorienteers

NEXT ISSUE

To submit any articles for the next issue or be valid to enter the caption competition.

Email me at – newsletter@pfo.org.uk

WORD SEARCH – Water Features

G	V	M	A	R	S	H	O	R	E	L	T	P	E
S	P	W	H	C	T	I	D	R	P	D	D	R	N
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Well Trough Stream River Pond Lake

Marsh Spring Water-hole Ditch